

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Internal Audit Checklist — Vendor Controls

Q1 2024 internal audit review of the Northwind engagement.

Document ID	AUD-101
Owner	Internal Audit
Audit Period	Q1 2024
Entity Reviewed	Northwind Cloud Systems LLC
Status	Fieldwork complete

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Audit Objective

Assess whether Northwind control design and retained evidence align with Meridian policy requirements, contractual commitments, and operational oversight expectations for the planned production deployment.

Checklist Results

Control Test	Expected Evidence	Result	Reviewer Note
Signed DPA on file	Executed DPA with transfer terms	Partial	DPA executed, but Appendix C (SCCs) is not attached.
Privileged access approval evidence complete	Approval email + owner sign-off for vendor admins	Fail	Approval record for two standing vendor admin accounts not in evidence vault.
Incident-notification obligation aligned to policy	Explicit 24-hour or 48-hour clause	Fail	Contract and policy still rely on “reasonable efforts” or undefined timing.
Subprocessor change workflow documented	Formal notice process and objection path	Partial	Portal update only; formal notice package requested.
SLA availability target aligned to business criticality	99.95% monthly or approved exception	Partial	Current SLA at 99.5%; temporary risk acceptance proposed.

Conclusion: control design is partially adequate, but evidence quality and contract alignment gaps require remediation before full close-out.